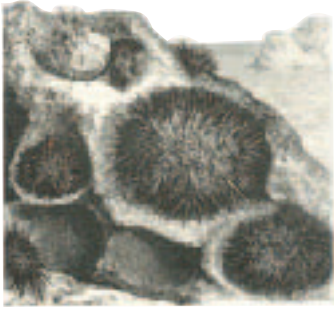




Sea urchin boring into rocks



Piddock

ROCK BORERS

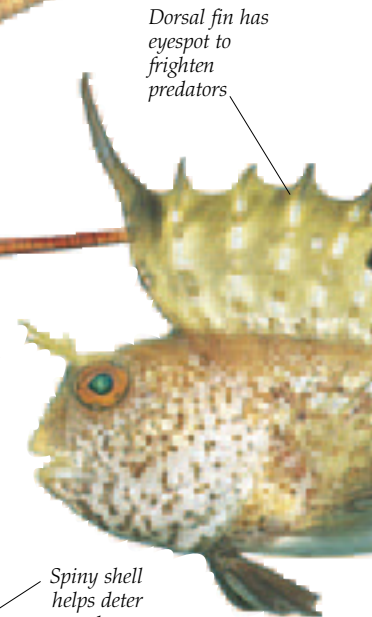
Some sea urchins use their spines and teeth beneath their shells to bore spaces in rock, while piddocks drill with the tips of their shells. Using its muscular foot, the piddock twists and turns to drill and hold onto its burrow. Both are found in shallow water and on the lower shore.

Rocks underwater

ROCKS MAKE UP THE SEABED in coastal waters, where currents sweep away any sand and mud. With the strong water movement, animals must cling onto rocks, find crevices to hide in, or shelter in seaweeds. A few remarkable animals, such as the piddocks (clams) and some sea urchins, can bore into solid rock to make their homes. Sea urchins bore cavities in hard rock while piddocks drill into softer rocks such as sandstone and chalk. Some animals hide under small stones, but only if they are lodged in the soft seabed. Where masses of loose pebbles roll around, animals and seaweeds can be crushed. However, some crustaceans, such as lobsters, can regrow a lost limb crushed by a stone and starfish can regrow a missing arm. Some animals can survive on the seashore's lower levels, especially rock pools, but many need to be continually submerged.

BEAUTIFUL BUTTERFLY

Blennies, small fishes living in shallow water, often rest on the bottom and hide in crannies. They lay their eggs in sheltered places, such as abandoned bottles, and guard them from predators. Blennies feed on small creatures, such as mites, and live on rocky or stony ground to depths of 65 ft (20 m).

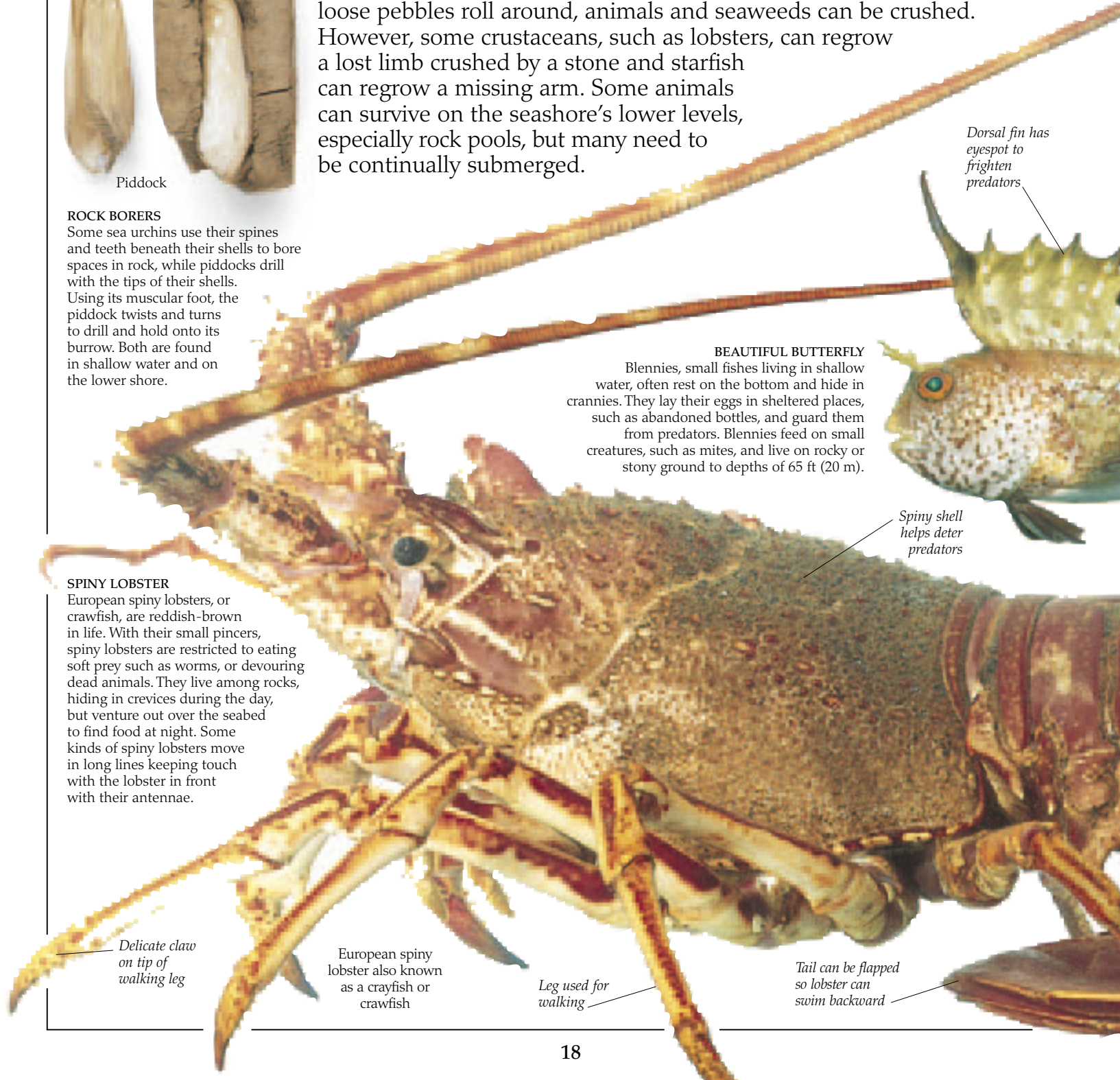


Dorsal fin has eyespot to frighten predators

Spiny shell helps deter predators

SPINY LOBSTER

European spiny lobsters, or crawfish, are reddish-brown in life. With their small pincers, spiny lobsters are restricted to eating soft prey such as worms, or devouring dead animals. They live among rocks, hiding in crevices during the day, but venture out over the seabed to find food at night. Some kinds of spiny lobsters move in long lines keeping touch with the lobster in front with their antennae.



Delicate claw on tip of walking leg

European spiny lobster also known as a crayfish or crawfish

Leg used for walking

Tail can be flapped so lobster can swim backward